

BPO Abbreviations Handbook

Call Center, Technical & Sales terms — explained with real examples



About the Trainer

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He works as an interview coach and educational content creator, helping Arabic-speaking fresh graduates and job seekers get comfortable with the everyday abbreviations used across BPO floors — operations, technical support, and sales — written in simple, clear English.

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آيات وأحاديث في فضل طلب العلم

وَقُلْ رَبِّ زِدْنِي عِلْمًا

سورة طه: 114

يَرْفَعُ اللَّهُ الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا مِنْكُمْ وَالَّذِينَ أُوتُوا الْعِلْمَ دَرَجَاتٍ

سورة المجادلة: 11

«وَمَنْ سَلَكَ طَرِيقًا يَلْتَمِسُ فِيهِ عِلْمًا سَهَّلَ اللَّهُ لَهُ بِهِ طَرِيقًا إِلَى الْجَنَّةِ»

رواه مسلم

«مَنْ يُرِدِ اللَّهُ بِهِ خَيْرًا يُعَفِّهِ فِي الدِّينِ»

متفق عليه (رواه البخاري ومسلم)

Part 1 — Call Center Operations Abbreviations

Abbr.	Full Form	Meaning & Use / Example
FCR	First Call Resolution	Solving the customer's issue completely during the first call, with no need for a follow-up. "Our team achieved 85% FCR this month, so fewer customers had to call back."
AHT	Average Handle Time	The average total time an agent spends on one interaction, including talk time and after-call work. "Her AHT was 6 minutes, which is right within the target."
ACW	After Call Work	The time an agent spends finishing notes or tasks right after a call ends, before taking the next one. "Please complete your ACW quickly so you're ready for the next call."
ACD	Automatic Call Distributor	The system that automatically routes incoming calls to the next available agent. "The ACD sent the call to the billing queue automatically."
IVR	Interactive Voice Response	The automated phone menu customers hear and select options from before reaching an agent. "Press 2 on the IVR to reach technical support."
SLA	Service Level Agreement	An agreed standard for how quickly a request must be answered or resolved. "Our SLA requires 90% of calls to be answered within 30 seconds."
CSAT	Customer Satisfaction Score	A score, usually from a short survey, showing how happy a customer was with one interaction. "He scored a 5/5 CSAT after I resolved his billing issue."
NPS	Net Promoter Score	A score showing how likely a customer is to recommend the company to others. "Our NPS went up after we improved our response times."
QA	Quality Assurance	The process of monitoring and scoring calls to make sure agents follow standards. "The QA team listened to my call and gave me feedback on my tone."

KPI	Key Performance Indicator	A measurable target used to track how well an agent, team, or process is performing. <i>"AHT and CSAT are two of the main KPIs we track every week."</i>
CRM	Customer Relationship Management	Software used to store and manage customer information, history, and interactions. <i>"I updated the customer's request in our CRM before ending the call."</i>
WFM	Workforce Management	The team or system responsible for planning schedules and staffing based on call volume. <i>"WFM adjusted my shift because call volume is higher this week."</i>
ASA	Average Speed of Answer	The average time it takes for a call to be answered by an agent. <i>"Our ASA improved after we hired more agents for the morning shift."</i>
CES	Customer Effort Score	A score measuring how easy or difficult it was for the customer to get their issue solved. <i>"A low CES means customers found it easy to resolve their problem."</i>
SME	Subject Matter Expert	A team member with deep knowledge of a specific process, used to help others with harder cases. <i>"I escalated the technical question to our SME on the floor."</i>
OJT	On-the-Job Training	Practical training given to a new agent while actually handling real or simulated calls. <i>"New hires spend one week in OJT before taking calls alone."</i>
RCA	Root Cause Analysis	A process used to find the real, underlying reason behind a recurring problem. <i>"We did an RCA and found the billing errors were caused by a system glitch."</i>
AUX	Auxiliary (Agent Status Code)	A status code showing why an agent is not available to take calls (break, training, meeting). <i>"He put himself on AUX for his 15-minute break."</i>

Part 2 — Technical Support Abbreviations

Abbr.	Full Form	Meaning & Use / Example
IP	Internet Protocol	The address system that identifies a device connected to a network or the internet. <i>"Can you confirm the IP address showing on your router settings?"</i>
LAN	Local Area Network	A network connecting devices within one building or home, usually using cables or Wi-Fi. <i>"All computers in the office are connected through the same LAN."</i>
WAN	Wide Area Network	A larger network that connects devices across cities or countries, like the internet itself. <i>"Your connection to our servers travels through our WAN."</i>
DNS	Domain Name System	The system that translates website names into IP addresses so browsers can find them. <i>"If a website won't load, we sometimes ask you to reset your DNS settings."</i>
VPN	Virtual Private Network	A secure, private connection used to access the internet safely, especially remotely. <i>"Our support agents use a VPN to securely access the company system from home."</i>
ISP	Internet Service Provider	The company that provides internet access to homes and businesses. <i>"As your ISP, we can check if there's an outage in your area."</i>
SIM	Subscriber Identity Module	The small card in a phone that identifies the customer's mobile account and number. <i>"Please remove and reinsert your SIM card, then restart your phone."</i>
IMEI	International Mobile Equipment Identity	A unique number that identifies a specific mobile device. <i>"I'll need your IMEI number to report the phone as lost."</i>
OS	Operating System	The main software that runs a device, like Windows, iOS, or Android. <i>"Please check which OS version your phone is currently running."</i>
RAM	Random Access Memory	The device's short-term memory used to run apps and programs while it's on. <i>"Low RAM can make your device slow when many apps are open."</i>
HDD/SSD	Hard Disk Drive / Solid State Drive	The parts of a computer that store files and data permanently. <i>"An SSD is faster than an HDD when opening files."</i>
USB	Universal Serial Bus	A common cable and port type used to connect devices, chargers, and storage. <i>"Please connect the modem to your computer using the USB cable provided."</i>
VoIP	Voice over Internet Protocol	Technology that allows phone calls to be made using the internet instead of a phone line. <i>"Our home phone service works through VoIP, so it needs an internet connection."</i>
Mbps	Megabits per second	The unit used to measure internet speed. <i>"Your plan includes speeds up to 100 Mbps."</i>
4G/5G	Fourth/Fifth Generation (Mobile Network)	The generation of mobile network technology used for data and calls. <i>"5G offers faster speeds than 4G in supported areas."</i>
Wi-Fi	Wireless Fidelity	The technology that allows devices to connect to a network without cables. <i>"Try forgetting the Wi-Fi network on your phone, then reconnecting."</i>

Part 3 — Sales Abbreviations

Abbr.	Full Form	Meaning & Use / Example
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ROI	Return on Investment	A measure of the profit gained compared to the money spent. <i>"This upgrade offer gives customers a strong ROI on their monthly plan."</i>
B2B	Business to Business	Sales made from one company directly to another company. <i>"Our B2B team handles bulk internet plans for offices."</i>
B2C	Business to Consumer	Sales made directly from a company to individual customers. <i>"Most of our call center's sales are B2C, one customer at a time."</i>
CTA	Call To Action	A clear instruction that encourages the customer to take the next step. <i>"End every pitch with a strong CTA, like 'Shall I activate this for you today?'"</i>
USP	Unique Selling Proposition	The special feature that makes a product different and better than competitors. <i>"Our USP is 24/7 live support with no wait time."</i>
CLV/LTV	Customer Lifetime Value	The total revenue a business expects from one customer over the whole relationship. <i>"Retaining customers longer increases their LTV significantly."</i>
CPA	Cost Per Acquisition	The average cost a company spends to gain one new customer. <i>"Our marketing team is working to lower the CPA this quarter."</i>
CPL	Cost Per Lead	The average cost of getting one potential customer's contact information. <i>"The new campaign reduced our CPL by 20%."</i>
MRR	Monthly Recurring Revenue	The predictable income a company earns every month from subscriptions. <i>"Each new subscription plan adds to our MRR."</i>
ARR	Annual Recurring Revenue	The total predictable income a company earns from subscriptions in one year. <i>"Our ARR grew after we introduced annual contract discounts."</i>
POS	Point of Sale	The place or system where a customer completes a purchase. <i>"The upgrade was processed right at the point of sale."</i>
AE	Account Executive	A sales professional responsible for managing and growing client accounts. <i>"I was promoted from agent to Account Executive after two years."</i>
SDR	Sales Development Representative	A team member who finds and qualifies new leads before passing them to a closer. <i>"The SDR team passed me three qualified leads this morning."</i>
YOY	Year Over Year	A comparison of performance between the same period in two different years. <i>"Sales grew 15% YOY compared to last year."</i>
MOM	Month Over Month	A comparison of performance between the current month and the previous month. <i>"Our upsell rate improved 5% MOM."</i>
COD	Cash on Delivery	A payment method where the customer pays when the product is delivered. <i>"He chose COD, so he'll pay the courier upon delivery."</i>